

FREE QUICK-START GUIDE

DIY Crafts Side-Hustle Quick-Start

A practical, no-fluff way to choose one handmade product, price it thoughtfully, and take your first small sales steps.

START SMALL. LEARN FAST. KEEP IT SIMPLE.

Created by T. Lott • Artistry Store

Do not start with a whole shop.

Start with one repeatable item you can make well, photograph clearly, and explain in one sentence.

Good first-product qualities

- Uses materials you can easily replace
- Can be made in a small batch
- Solves a gifting, decorating, organizing, or everyday-use need
- Does not require custom work at first

Examples

Bookmark sets • seasonal gift tags • hand-poured candle favors • personalized vinyl cups • printable craft kits

Your one-sentence offer

"I make _____ for _____ who want _____."

Tip: Avoid promising medical, safety, or income results. Sell the actual item and its practical use.

Get proof of interest first.

You do not need a giant inventory to test an idea. Make 1–3 clean samples and ask real people what they would choose.

Use this mini validation test

- Photograph the sample in natural light.
- Show two color or style choices.
- Ask: “Which would you give as a gift?”
- Offer a small first batch or preorder only if you can fulfill it.

Ask, don’t assume

“If this were available for \$____, would you want one for yourself or as a gift?”

Write this down

People chose: _____

Most-requested color/style: _____

Questions they asked: _____

Price feedback: _____

Know your real cost.

Before setting a price, write down the cost to make one item—including the small things that add up.

Per-item costs

Materials: \$ _____

Packaging: \$ _____

Platform/payment fees: \$ _____

Shipping supplies: \$ _____

Total cash cost: \$ _____

Your time

Minutes to make one: _____

Hourly amount you want to earn: \$ _____

Time value per item: \$ _____

Full cost: \$ _____

Simple pricing reminder

Full cost + room for mistakes and profit = starting price. If your price feels too high, simplify the item, buy smarter in small quantities, or choose a different first product. Do not quietly work for free.

Help a buyer understand it fast.

Your first listing does not need fancy language. It needs clear photos, accurate details, and a simple next step.

Use this listing formula

Title: what it is + key style or use.

First line: “A _____ made for _____.”

Details: size, materials, colors, what is included, processing time, care instructions, and anything a buyer should know before ordering.

Call to action: “Choose your option and order when you’re ready.”

Photo checklist

- One clean full-product image
- One close-up showing texture or detail
- One photo showing size or use
- One photo of packaging, if included

Keep it original

Use your own photos and designs. Do not copy another seller’s images, wording, or protected characters.

Small, repeatable action beats waiting.

Pick a short launch window and tell people exactly what is available. The goal is to learn what buyers respond to—not to become perfect overnight.

Five-day mini launch

- Day 1: Make and photograph your sample.
- Day 2: Ask for feedback on two options.
- Day 3: Finalize price, details, and fulfillment plan.
- Day 4: Publish one accurate listing or order form.
- Day 5: Share a short post showing the item, who it is for, and how to order.

Simple post prompt

“I’m testing a small batch of [product]. It is made for [person/use]. Comment or message me if you want the details.”

Track the basics from day one.

A simple notebook or spreadsheet is enough at the beginning. Record every sale and every supply purchase so you can see what is actually working.

For each sale, note

- Date
- Item sold
- Amount received
- Materials and fees
- Delivery or pickup status

Weekly review

What got the most interest? _____

What took too long to make? _____

Which question kept coming up? _____

What will I test next week? _____

Business note

Rules for taxes, permits, product safety, and shipping vary by location and product. Check the requirements that apply to you before selling.

Choose one product. Take one action today.

You now have a starting point—not a guarantee. Build confidence by making a clear offer, listening to buyers, and improving one small batch at a time.

My 48-hour action

The person I will ask for feedback: _____

The date I will publish my first listing: _____

More practical resources

Visit shop.artistrystore.com/store.html for more practical resources from T. Lott.

Important note

Personal educational use only. This guide is not legal, tax, or financial advice, and individual results will vary.